

Equinor ASA

Recommendation **SELL** ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Price **NOK 375.50** [as of market close Oct 20, 2023] **12-Mo. Target Price** **NOK 260.00** **Report Currency** **USD** **Investment Style** **Large-Cap Blend**

Equity Analyst **Jeff Lye, CFA**

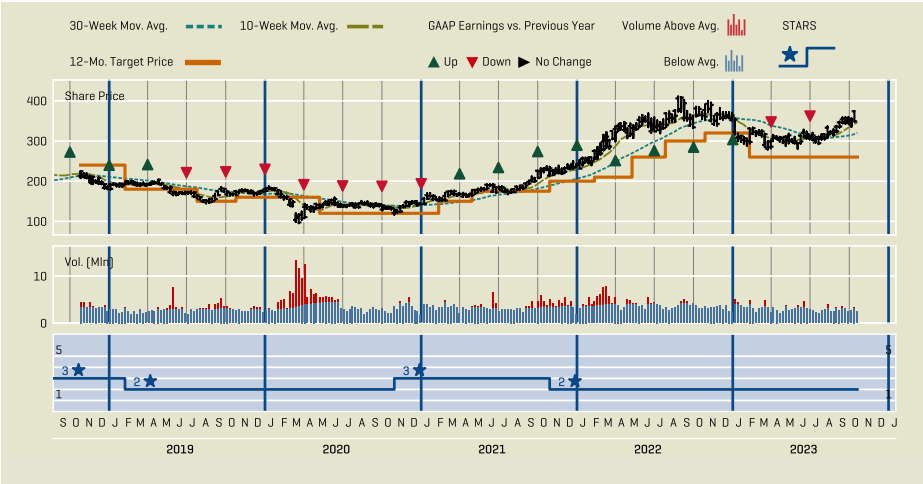
GICS Sector Energy
Sub-Industry Integrated Oil and Gas

Summary Norway-based Equinor is an upstream oil and gas company, and the world's leading deep offshore operator, principally in the Norwegian continental shelf.

Key Stock Statistics [Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports]

52-Wk Range	NOK 399.95 - 278.7	Oper.EPS2023E	USD 4.70	Market Capitalization[B]	NOK 1110.64	Beta	0.63
Trailing 12-Month EPS	USD 5.83	Oper.EPS2024E	USD 4.70	Yield [%]	2.3	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	30
Trailing 12-Month P/E	5.82	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	7.22	Dividend Rate/Share	NOK 8.63	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	B-
NOK 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	22,085.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	3,042.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	NOK 28.9	Institutional Ownership [%]	25.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Jeff Lye, CFA** on Jul 26, 2023 08:49 AM ET, when the stock traded at **NOK 310.00**.

Highlights

- Equinor's Q2 2023 adjusted net income of USD2.25 billion [-57% Y/Y; -36% Q/Q] was within expectations. The earnings decline was due to lower energy price realizations, specifically its Q2 2023 E&P Norway average internal gas price weakened to USD10.2/mmtu versus USD25.5/mmtu in Q2 2022 and USD17.4 in Q1 2023. Net debt-to-capital employed increased in Q2 2023 to -35% [-52% as of Mar-2023] owing to unfavorable tax phasing totaling ~USD10 billion and high capital distribution.
- LNG prices have retraced significantly, Dutch TTF fell below EUR30/MWh (2022: EUR131/MWh) and Henry Hub dropped below USD2/mmtu (2022: USD6.54/mmbtu) before paring some losses amid summer. Moreover, we think high energy storage levels in European nations and an increasing risk of storage congestion may reduce the level of anticipated gas price increase during 2023/2024 winter, thus putting further downside pressure on Equinor's profitability in 2023. Operationally, we estimate Equinor to raise its hydrocarbon production by around 3% in 2023, supported by new fields from Johan Sverdrup Phase 2 and Njord on stream, alongside production ramp-up from Peregrino fields.
- We forecast EPS of USD4.70 for both 2023 and 2024.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- Our call is 2-STARs [Sell]. As the largest gas supplier in Europe with nearly 40% of hydrocarbon output being contributed by indigenous gas production, Equinor is uniquely positioned to support the energy transition of European nations which are focused on seeking alternative sources of fossil fuels to reduce energy dependency on Russia. However, LNG prices have retraced significantly, resulting in EPS headwinds versus the high base in 2022. We think the high level of energy storage across European nations [that we believe may be full by the end-Q3 2023] will avert the fear of an energy crisis during 2023/2024 winter. Such development will reduce the level of anticipated gas prices ahead of winter and lower Equinor's profitability, in our view. Also, we think the planned capital distribution in 2023 is arguably backward-looking and unsustainable.
- Upside risks that may prompt us to raise our recommendation and/or target price include increase in oil and gas prices and potential value crystallization from assets spin-off.
- Our 12-month target price for Equinor is NOK260, reflecting a P/NAV of 1.6x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified in our view by Equinor's superior ROE profile.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW	MEDIUM	HIGH
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Our risk assessment reflects Equinor's stable production outlook for the next decade, its low production costs, solid balance sheet, strong cash flow, and robust exploration prospects.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	--	--	--	--	€ 110,000
2023	29,211	22,870	--	--	€ 115,000
2022	36,050	36,387	42,725	33,841	150,806
2021	17,549	17,462	23,111	32,125	88,744
2020	15,065	7,563	11,339	11,746	45,818
2019	16,410	16,897	14,704	14,900	62,911

Earnings Per Share (USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	--	--	--	--	€ 4.70
2023	1.12	0.74	--	--	€ 4.70
2022	1.60	1.56	2.13	1.85	7.13
2021	0.57	0.60	0.86	1.35	3.09
2020	-0.21	0.20	-0.65	-0.75	-1.69
2019	0.46	0.34	0.32	0.36	1.48

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [NOK]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
--	Jul 26	Nov 14	Nov 15	Nov 28 '23
--	Jul 26	Nov 14	Nov 15	Nov 28 '23
3.1364	May 04	Aug 14	Aug 15	Aug 25 '23
6.2727	May 04	Aug 14	Aug 15	Aug 25 '23
6.3835	Feb 08	May 11	May 12	May 25 '23
3.1918	Feb 08	May 11	May 12	May 25 '23

Dividends have been paid since 2002 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.

Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.

Equinor ASA

Business Summary Jul 26, 2023

COMPANY BACKGROUND: Equinor ASA (previously known as Statoil) began operations in 1972 as Den norske stats oljeselskap a.s., with a primary focus on exploration, development, and production of oil and gas in the Norwegian Continental Shelf (NCS). It was renamed Statoil ASA in 2001 and converted into a public listed company, or ASA. In 2007, it merged with the Oil & Gas division of Norsk Hydro (Norway’s second-largest oil company and aluminum producer). About 67% of its shares are owned by the Norwegian State as of December 2022. The group is headquartered in Norway and is listed on the Oslo and New York Stock Exchanges. Equinor accounts for about 70% of all hydrocarbon production on the NCS, while it generates about one-third of its production outside of NCS in 13 countries worldwide.

DIVISIONAL OVERVIEW: Equinor operates across six reporting segments: Exploration & Production Norway (E&P Norway); Exploration & Production International (E&P International); Exploration & Production USA (E&P USA); Marketing, Midstream, and Processing (MMP); Renewables (REN); and Others. E&P Norway remains its largest contributing division with production of 1,387 kboe/d in 2022 and proven reserves of 3,708 million boe as of the end of 2022, making up 71% of the group’s total proven reserve. It is also the most profitable division, which contributed 88% of Equinor’s adjusted earnings in 2022.

E&P International is tasked with Equinor’s exploration, development, and production of oil and gas outside the NCS and the U.S., with production activities in Algeria, Angola, Azerbaijan, Brazil, Canada, Ireland, Libya, Nigeria, Russia, the U.K., and Venezuela. The division has average entitlement production of 235 kboe/day and made up 5% of Equinor’s adjusted earnings in 2022.

E&P USA covers both onshore and offshore exploration, development, and production of oil and gas in the U.S. The division has an average entitlement production of 279 kboe/day and made up 4% of Equinor’s adjusted earnings in 2022.

MMP, on the other hand, encompasses its midstream and downstream marketing, trading, transportation, and refining operations. It is responsible for about 70% of all Norwegian gas exports and is behind only Gazprom in terms of gas volume sold to Europe. The division operates two refineries in Norway and Denmark and has majority stakes in Europe’s largest methanol plant at Tjeldbergodden. MMP made up 3% of Equinor’s adjusted earnings in 2022.

REN focuses on offshore wind and integrated solutions for onshore renewable. The group has installed a renewables capacity of 0.6 GW as of the end of 2022 and has produced 1,641 GWh of renewable energy in 2022. The Other segment, meanwhile, includes activities in Projects, Drilling, and Procurement; Technology, Digital & Innovation; and corporate functions.

HYDROCARBON PRODUCTION: Equinor’s 2022 oil and gas equity production fell 2% Y/Y to 2,039 kboe/day owing to a natural decline and divestments (including its exit from Russia). Equinor targets to deliver around 3% of organic production growth (rebased for divestment) in 2023 supported by new fields from Johan Sverdrup Phase 2 and Njord on stream, alongside production ramp-up from Peregrino Phase 1 and Phase 2. Estimated proved reserves were 5.2 billion boe as of the end of 2022, with 87% of resources located in OECD countries. The 2022 reserves replacement ratio was 76%, though it is higher than the three-year historical average of 62%.

CORPORATE STRATEGY: In order to navigate through industry cycles and achieve a robust transition towards renewables and low-carbon solutions, Equinor remains disciplined on cost and capital investment. Under its updated outlook, Equinor guides for organic capex of USD 10 billion in 2023 followed by annual average organic capex of USD13 billion [at USD/NOK foreign currency rate assumption of 10] over 2024-2026, compared to USD8.3 billion spent in 2022. It also targets to reduce unit production cost to below USD6/boe over 2023-2026, from USD6.1/boe achieved during 2022. Balance sheet optimization will also be prioritized in the near term and the company looks to re-leverage to increase its net debt ratio towards the long-term optimal range of 15%-30%. These measures are expected to deliver around USD20 billion of annual organic cash flow from 2023 through 2030 at Brent oil price of around USD70/boe and achieve a high Return on Average Capital Employed (ROACE) of >15% over the period.

FINANCIAL TRENDS: Equinor’s financial performance jumped to adjusted earnings of USD75.0 billion in 2022 from USD33.5 billion in 2021, driven by exceptionally high hydrocarbon price realizations. ROACE bounced to 55.2% in 2022 from 22.7% in 2021, above its long-term target of 15%. The company generated free cash flow of USD23.3 billion in 2022, reducing its net debt-to-capital employed to -24% in 2022 from -1% in 2021. Equinor deems its latest capital structure to be inefficient and intends to re-leverage by distributing around USD17 billion of capital in 2023 to shareholders through dividends and share buybacks.

Corporate information

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President & CEO

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Senior VP of Legal & General Counsel

H. H. Klouman

Independent Chair of the Board

J. Erik Reinhardsen

Executive Vice President of Technology, Digital & Innovation

H. Skryseth

Chief Accountant

M. Haukaas

Board Members

A. Drinkwater

J. Erik Reinhardsen

A. S. Myking

J. Lewis

C. K. Marti

J. Roth

D. U. Mongstad

J. T. Føsum

F. Kinserdal

K. R. Braathen

F. Ruyter

M. Rege

H. Aasen

N. H. Bastiansen

H. Bruun-Hanssen

P. A. Koch

H. E. Haldorsen

R. G. Herlofsen

J. Birkeland

S. Laegreid

Domicile

Norway

Auditor

Ernst & Young LLP

Founded

1972

Employees

21,936

Stockholders

N/A

Equinor ASA

Quantitative Evaluations						Expanded Ratio Analysis					
Fair Value Rank	NR	1	2	3	4	5	2022	2021	2020	2019	
LOWEST						HIGHEST	Price/Sales	0.76	0.98	1.21	1.06
Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued (1) to most undervalued (5).							Price/Tangible Book Value	2.28	2.66	2.13	2.17
							Price/Pretax Income	1.45	2.76	NM	7.16
							P/E Ratio	5.01	8.68	59.98	13.51
							Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	3,183.00	3,254.00	3,269.00	3,334.00
						Figures based on fiscal year-end price					
Volatility	NA	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH	Key Growth Rates and Averages Past Growth Rate [%] 1 Year3 Years5 Years Net Income235.70149.8544.33 Revenue67.9033.3019.57 Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.) Net Margin [%]19.295.635.88 % LT Debt to Capitalization28.0234.9633.83				
Technical Evaluation	BEARISH	Since May, 2023, the technical indicators for EQNR NO have been BEARISH"									
Insider Activity	NA	UNFAVORABLE		NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE					

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31											
Per Share Data [USD]		2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value		15.64	10.07	7.92	9.20	10.00	9.43	7.99	9.70	12.51	83.05
Free Cash Flow		8.36	6.37	0.58	1.07	2.50	1.24	-1.06	-0.59	0.22	-4.28
Earnings		9.03	2.63	-1.69	0.55	2.27	1.40	-0.91	-1.63	1.21	12.50
Earnings (Normalized)		7.13	3.09	0.28	1.48	2.01	1.39	-0.07	0.72	1.62	2.35
Dividends		0.90	0.71	0.41	1.05	0.95	0.89	0.88	0.86	0.96	7.00
Payout Ratio [%]		18.72	20.99	NM	181.00	35.46	32.48	NM	NM	142.00	53.88
Prices: High		42.40	28.15	21.10	23.82	28.92	21.66	18.48	21.85	32.01	24.43
Prices: Low		26.02	16.85	9.29	16.03	21.74	16.24	10.96	13.89	15.81	20.00
P/E Ratio: High		5.80	9.20	77.50	15.70	13.50	15.60	NM	25.30	16.10	10.40
P/E Ratio: Low		3.30	5.30	39.40	11.10	9.80	12.00	NM	17.80	9.70	8.60
Income Statement Analysis [Million USD]											
Revenue		149,004	88,744	45,765	62,911	78,556	60,972	45,688	57,901	96,708	616,600
Depreciation + Amortization		10,069	10,606	11,348	13,817	10,211	9,691	12,050	13,353	13,888	68,500
Operating Expenses		2,629	2,369	4,601	3,119	2,624	2,210	4,134	5,274	6,422	29,000
Effective Tax Rate [%]		63.40	72.80	-29.00	80.10	60.10	65.70	-1,530	9,500	78.30	71.60
Net Income		28,746	8,563	NM	1,843	7,535	4,590	NM	NM	3,871	39,900
Net Income [Normalized]		46,828	19,779	1,035	6,953	11,050	7,447	526.90	2,391	12,228	80,038
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data [Million USD]											
Gross Property		199,586	212,234	215,587	209,219	194,916	188,656	172,579	165,406	175,296	1,095,100
Net Property		56,498	62,075	68,508	71,751	65,262	63,637	59,556	62,006	75,619	487,400
Capital Expenditures		8,611	8,151	8,476	10,204	11,367	10,755	12,191	15,518	19,497	114,900
Capital Expend to Revenue [%]		5.80	9.20	18.50	16.20	14.50	17.60	26.70	26.80	20.20	18.60
% Long Term Debt of Capitalization		28.00	36.40	40.40	31.00	33.30	35.50	41.90	41.30	33.50	30.70
Capitalization: Common		53,988	39,010	33,873	41,139	42,970	39,861	35,072	40,271	51,225	355,500
Capitalization: Preferred		N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Fixed Charges Coverage		88.88	49.13	2.56	10.79	31.20	13.60	0.95	5.68	18.80	100.86
% Operating Ratio		55.26	47.17	30.27	38.99	35.96	35.72	28.07	31.13	33.86	34.01
% Net Income Margin		19.29	9.65	-12.04	2.93	9.59	7.53	-6.40	-8.97	4.00	6.47
% Return on Invested Capital		56.71	27.32	2.20	9.64	16.47	11.20	0.69	3.77	15.26	18.05
% Return on Common Equity		61.80	23.50	-14.70	4.40	18.20	12.30	-7.80	-11.30	7.80	11.80

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Equinor ASA

Industry Outlook

Following the outperformance of European Energy sector in 2022 (EMEA Energy up 32% versus S&P 350 down 12%), the sector was largely flat in 2023 (YTD August), underperforming S&P 350, which was up 10%. Consequently, the Energy sector PE multiple versus S&P 350 has widened and is now at close to a 50% discount, approaching the lower end of its historical discount against S&P350 of 50-60%. We think the current discount is becoming more reasonable, but weak global economic activities deter us from turning fully positive on the EMEA Energy sector, therefore maintaining our opinion of Market Weight for European Energy.

World oil supply growth is expected to slow to 1.4 million barrels per day (mb/d) in 2023 versus 4.7 mb/d growth in 2022, according to International Energy Agency (IEA), as production expansion from Non-Opec+ (i.e., U.S. and Brazil) will be partially offset by a production cut by OPEC+. OPEC+ cut its crude oil production to a near two-year low in July 2023 as a major voluntary cut by Saudi Arabia took effect. The voluntary cut is expected to continue till September 2023 and to be extended if necessary.

According to IEA, oil demand in 2023 is set to rise by 2.2 mb/d to a record high of 102.1 mb/d, surpassing the pre-pandemic level. The rise in demand is expected to be led by the gain from non-OECD countries, specifically China, rather than OECD countries. Therefore, we think there may be a risk for the strong demand forecast to fall through, given that China's recovery appears to be lackluster with multiple GDP forecast downgrades following its release of Q2 2023 economic data. Meanwhile, the global oil inventories have grown steadily in H1 2023, easing the tremendous tightness felt by the industry previously.

As we access the supply and demand holistically, we think the additional OPEC+ cut in H2 2023 may result in increasing draws in inventories and oil on water, thus limiting further build-up whilst introducing renewed volatility to the market. As of August 2023, EIA forecasts Brent crude oil prices

averaging USD82/barrel in 2023 and USD86/barrel in 2024. Although the forecasts may not be as robust as 2022's USD101/barrel, the gradual improvement versus its previous May 2023 forecast of USD79/barrel in 2023 and USD74/barrel in 2024 certainly signals rowing optimism in oil prices, in our view.

Overall, we expect that integrated oil players, particularly those that have a dominant contribution from exploration and production will generate lower earnings in 2023 because the negative pricing effect will likely offset any small increase in volumes. Also, significantly lower refining margins will drag the earnings of integrated oil players. Cash yield to shareholders is expected to be substantial in 2023, but we think it may experience a steep step-down in 2024 as free cash flow drops and companies become more leveraged.

Meanwhile, we remain more positive on the energy equipment and service providers after a transition year in 2022, where they executed contracts won during the prior trough period, which in our view, generated lower margins. We believe their improving order books with favorable pricing and payment terms alongside stronger tender pipelines are likely to boost 2023 earnings. Furthermore, we believe they will be catalyzed by the reduced availability of energy and service providers alongside growth in the offshore renewable space.

/ Jeff Lye, CFA

Sub-Industry: Integrated Oil and Gas Peer Group*: Integrated Oil and Gas												
Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
Equinor ASA	EQNR NO	OB	USD	375.50	1,110,643.0	5.5	1.9	6.0	N/A	2.3	52.9	27.9
BP Plc	BP LN	LSE	USD	5.45	91,869.0	4.2	18.3	6.0	N/A	4.2	23.4	32.4
Eni	ENI IM	BIT	EUR	15.40	50,233.0	1.1	27.3	5.0	N/A	5.8	17.2	24.8
Galp Energia, SGPS, S.A.	GALP PT	ENXTLS	EUR	14.54	11,847.0	3.7	45.0	12.0	N/A	3.6	31.5	30.6
OMV	OMV AV	WBAG	EUR	42.21	13,783.0	-7.9	5.5	4.0	N/A	6.6	10.7	19.6
Repsol	REP SM	BME	EUR	14.88	19,006.0	-3.1	12.9	3.0	N/A	3.8	12.4	18.7
Royal Dutch Shell Plc	SHEL LN	LSE	USD	27.28	180,322.0	5.1	17.6	7.0	N/A	3.5	15.1	16.2
Royal Dutch Shell Plc	SHELL NA	ENXTAM	USD	31.77	207,112.0	4.6	19.2	7.0	N/A	3.4	15.1	16.2
Total SA	TTE FP	ENXTPA	USD	62.57	149,192.0	0.4	18.2	6.0	N/A	4.7	16.9	19.3

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.
NA- Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.
Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Equinor ASA

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

July 26, 2023

08:02 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 310.00**]: We keep our target price of NOK260, reflecting a P/NAV of 1.6x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified in our view by its superior ROE profile. We lower our EPS forecast for 2023 and 2024 to USD4.70 [from USD5.00]. Q2 2023 adjusted net income of USD2.25 billion [-57% Y/Y; -36% Q/Q] was within expectations. The earnings decline was due to lower energy price realizations, specifically its Q2 2023 E&P Norway average internal gas price weakened to USD10.2/mmtu versus USD25.5/mmtu in Q2 2022 and USD17.4 in Q1 2023. Net debt-to-capital employed increased in Q2 2023 to -35% [-52% as of Mar. 2023] owing to unfavorable tax phasing totaling ~USD10 billion and high capital distribution. Equinor kept its outlook alongside a planned cash return of USD17 billion for 2023. Meanwhile, energy storage levels in European nations are building up and we think there is an increasing risk of storage congestion towards end-Q3, which may reduce the level of anticipated gas price increase during 2023/2024 winter. / Jeff Lye, CFA

May 05, 2023

06:34 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 307.00**]: We keep our 12-month target price for Equinor of NOK260, reflecting a P/NAV of 1.8x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified in our view by Equinor's superior ROE profile. Q1 2023 adjusted net income of USD3.51 billion [-36% Y/Y] beat consensus estimates by 12%. The earnings beat was led by an exceptional profit from MMP on strong gas trading and gasoline margin, which partially mitigated the adverse impact of energy prices which significantly dragged the performance of E&P. Equinor kept its outlook and planned cash return of USD17 billion for 2023. Net debt-to-capital employed [ND/CE] reduced to -52% as of Mar-2023 from -24% as of Dec-2022 owing to higher post-tax CFFO of USD9.7 billion. Nonetheless, ND/CE is expected to increase in Q2 2023 owing to unfavorable tax phasing totaling ~USD10 billion and higher capital distribution. We cut our 2023 EPS forecasts to USD5.00 [from USD6.00] despite earnings beat in Q1 2023, accounting for lower gas prices in the remainder of 2023. Maintain Sell. / Jeff Lye, CFA

February 08, 2023

11:57 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 319.00**]: We cut our target price for Equinor to NOK260 [NOK320], reflecting a P/NAV of 1.8x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified in our view by Equinor's superior ROE profile. We keep our 2023 EPS forecasts at USD6.00 and set 2024 EPS at USD5.00. Although Q4 2022 adjusted net income of USD5.80 billion [+32% Y/Y; -14% Q/Q] beat consensus estimates by 42%, it was due to lower-than-expected effective tax rates. Q4 2022 adjusted operating income fell 38% Y/Y due to lower energy prices; specifically, its Q4 2022 E&P Norway average internal gas price weakened to USD27.22/mmtu versus USD42.34/mmtu in Q3 2022 and USD28.52 in Q4 2021. Equinor announced a capital distribution plan of USD17 billion in 2023, which we think is arguably backward-looking and unsustainable. LNG prices have retraced significantly, Dutch TTF fell to EUR50/MWh [2022: EUR131/MWh], and Henry Hub fell below USD3/mmtu [2022: USD6.54/mmbtu]. We think Equinor's earnings will fall as realization prices normalize, thus leaving valuation too rich. / Jeff Lye, CFA

October 28, 2022

10:14 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 376.00**]: We lift our 12-month target price for Equinor to NOK320 [NOK300], reflecting a P/NAV of 2.3x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified in our view by Equinor's superior ROE profile. We raise our normalized EPS forecasts to USD6.50 [USD6.00] for 2022 and USD6.00 [USD5.00] for 2023. Q3 2022 adjusted net income soared to USD6.72 billion [+142% Y/Y; +34% QoQ]. The group benefited from higher energy prices, specifically its Q3 2022 E&P Norway average internal gas price jumped to USD42.34/mmtu vs. USD25.53/mmtu in Q2 2022 and USD13.91 in Q3 2021. We think Equinor 2022 and 2023 earnings would be supported by elevated prices of gas future contracts, albeit significantly lower than its peak. However, sentiment over the shares of Equinor may be fluid, in our view, as a possible introduction of gas price cap in the European Union may dampen investors' optimism. This is particularly true since Equinor has risen >150% since 2021 and is trading at double its peer valuation. / Jeff Lye, CFA

July 27, 2022

01:52 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 355.00**]: We lift our 12-month target price for Equinor to NOK300 [NOK260], reflecting a P/

NAV of 2.3x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified, in our view, by Equinor's superior ROE profile. We raise our normalized EPS forecasts to USD6.00 [USD5.00] for 2022 and USD5.00 [USD4.00] for 2023. Q2 2022 adjusted net income soared to USD5.00 billion from USD1.59 billion a year ago. The group benefited from better energy prices, driven by sanction against Russia, as its revenues jumped 112% Y/Y to USD36.0 billion. Equinor decided to increase its special dividend and raise its share buyback program to USD6 billion [from USD5 billion] for 2022, which will bump its cash yield to around 10%. This provides better visibility on capital allocation, which should be much welcomed by the market, in our view. Although we think Equinor is well-positioned to deliver further earnings growth in 2022 given the favorable market condition, we maintain our view that its valuation is excessive at current levels. / Jeff Lye, CFA

May 10, 2022

01:16 AM ET... CFRA Keeps Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 321.85**]: We adjust our 12-month target price for Equinor to NOK260 [from NOK210], reflecting a P/NAV of 2.2x, a premium to peer average P/NAV of 1.2x, justified in our view by Equinor's superior ROE profile. We raise our normalized EPS forecasts to USD5.00 [from USD3.60] for 2022 and USD4.00 [from USD2.90] for 2023. Equinor's Q1 2022 normalized net income surged to USD5.18 billion from USD1.29 billion in Q1 2021 a year ago. Equinor benefited from higher energy prices, driven by Russia's invasion of Ukraine, as its revenues more than doubled to USD36.8 billion. This more than offset the USD1.1 billion net impairment during the quarter related to its Russian assets as the company announced its decision to stop new investments in the country and start the process of exiting its Russian joint ventures. While Equinor is well-positioned to deliver further earnings growth this year given the favorable market condition, we maintain our view that its valuation is excessive at current level. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

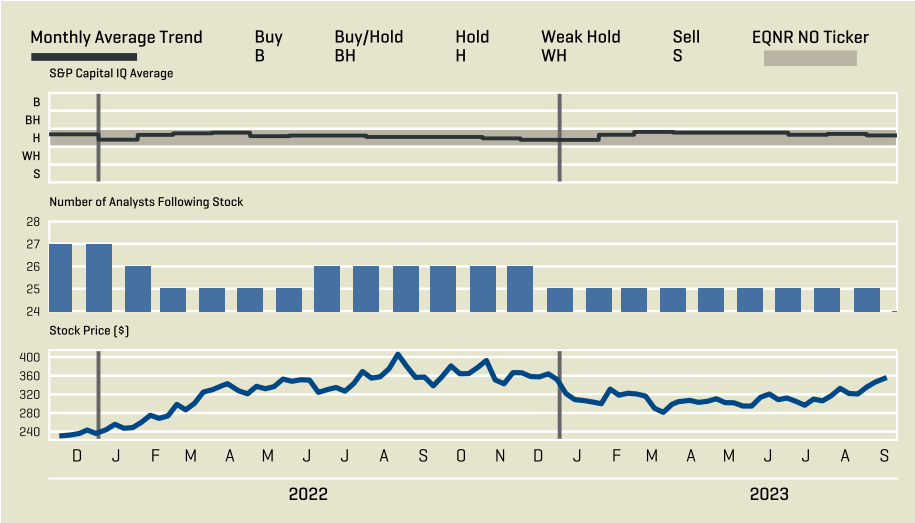
February 11, 2022

03:35 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Sell Opinion on Shares of Equinor [EQNR NO 268.00**]: We lift our target price on Equinor by NOK10 to NOK210, reflecting a P/NAV multiple of 2.0x, which is much higher than peers' average of 1.2x. The premium is justified in our view by its superior ROE and geopolitical risk profile. We raise our 2022 EPS estimate to USD3.6 [USD3.1] and we introduce a new forecast of USD2.9 for 2023. Equinor's adjusted net income rose further to USD4.4 billion during Q4 2021, beating company-compiled consensus by 20%. The outperformance was thanks to a combination of higher gas production, better realization prices, and lower effective tax rate. Notably, Equinor has decided to reward shareholders via a special dividend and higher share buybacks, which will bump its cash yield to above 10%. This provides better visibility on capital allocation, which should be much welcomed by the market. While the firm is well positioned to deliver further earnings growth this year given the favorable market condition, we maintain our view that Equinor's valuation is excessive at current level. / Jia Man Neoh, CFA

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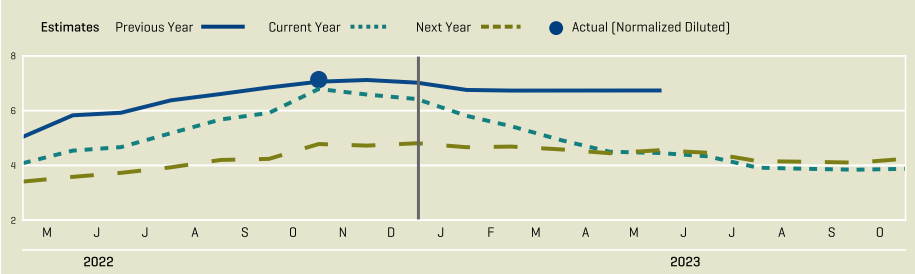
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Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	5	21	5	7
Buy/Hold	2	8	3	2
Hold	9	38	10	9
Weak hold	3	13	2	2
Sell	4	17	4	5
No Opinion	1	4	1	0
Total	24	100	25	25

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	4.23	5.30	3.26	20	89.37
2023	3.87	4.79	3.28	21	97.63
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 9%	▲ 11%	▼ -1%	▼ -5%	▼ -8%
Q3'24	1.00	1.15	0.85	2	377.42
Q3'23	0.76	0.88	0.61	6	498.50
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	▲ 32%	▲ 30%	▲ 40%	▼ -67%	▼ -24%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that EQNR NO will earn USD 3.87. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that EQNR NO's earnings per share will grow by 9.25% to USD 4.23.

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Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsule the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



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Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

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Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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